

Figure 3: Backup should run time selection

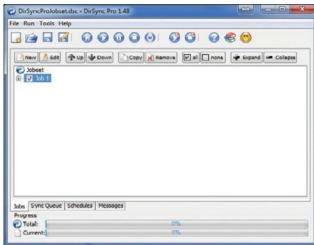


Figure 4: DirSync Pro console

Step 6 (for cloud-based backup): In the *Select a place to store the backups* window, select the *Google Docs* option and click *Next*.

Step 7 (for cloud-based backup): In the next window, enter the credentials for your Google Drive account, specify a *Google Docs Collection name* (a folder with this name will be created in Google Drive). Click *Next* once done and press *Yes* in the *Test Connection* window that pops up.

Step 8: In the *Advanced Settings* window check the *Select when and how often the backup should run* and leave other options as is. This is to schedule the backup at the desired frequency. Refer Figure 3.

Step 9: In the next window, select the desired interval from the drop down list, check/uncheck the *Allowed days* as per your requirements, and set the time of day when this backup should happen. For any frequency other than 'Daily' make sure the current day is checked in the *Allowed days* option.

In the *Full/Incremental Strategy* section select the *Incremental, then full after this period* option and select the month from the drop down list. This setting tells the

tool to perform incremental backups at the interval specified above and a full backup once every month.

Step 10: In the next window, check the *Run backup now* option and click *Next*. To check the status/progress of the backup, locate the Duplicati icon in the system tray and click on it.

Restore

This section will take you through the steps for restoring a backup.

Step 1: Launch Duplicati via *Start > All Programs > Duplicati*

Step 2: Select the *Restore files from a backup* option and click *Next*.

Step 3: In the next window, select the backup you want to restore.

Step 4: The next window will list all the available versions of the selected backup. Select the one you wish to restore and click *Next*.

Step 5: Set the path to restore the backup. If you want to restore only selected files or folders, check the *Restore only the items selected below* option and select the desired files.

Step 6: Click *Finish* in the next window to start the restore process. The status window will automatically appear above the system tray.

Duplicati is a great tool for secure backups. A good collection of how-tos on other storage options like FTP, SSH, etc, is available at <http://www.duplicati.com/howtos>.

DirSync Pro

Directory Synchronizer Pro, developed by O Givi, is a Java-based file and folder synchronisation tool. It is light on system resources and does the job of data backups perfectly. It comes with a graphical interface that is user-friendly and is easy to learn.

Notable features

- Portable
- Platform independent as it is Java-based
- Bi-directional and mono-directional synchronisation
- Provides standard synchronisation modes (Incremental, Mirror, Contribute and Custom)
- Users can set filters based on file names, file sizes, etc
- Bundles a powerful scheduling engine

Getting the tool and installing it

DirSync Pro can be downloaded from <http://www.dirsyncpro.org/download.html>. The download page lists variants for different operating systems. The current version, at the time of writing this article, is 1.48. Download the tool and install it.

Using the tool

Since this is a file and folder synchronisation tool, setting up a backup or restore job simply means creating a